(Nature is a British scientific magazine that publishes, quickly, announcements of discoveries in all fields of science and that has one of the highest worldwide circulations among serious scientific journals.)

Landau had friends in high places-high enough to arrange that, as soon as word was received back that Bohr had approved his article and had submitted it to *Nature*, a telegram would be sent to Bohr by the editorial staff of *Izvestia.* (*Izvestia* was one of the two most influential newspapers in the U.S.S.R., a newspaper run by and in behalf of the Soviet government.) The telegram went out on 16 November 1937 saying:

> Inform us, please, of your opinion of the work of Professor Landau. Telegraph to us, please, your brief conclusion.
>
> Editorial Staff, *Izvestia*

Bohr, evidently a bit puzzled and worried by the request, replied from Copenhagen that same day:

> The new idea of Professor Landau about neutron cores of massive stars is of the highest level of excellence and promise. I will be happy to send a short evaluation of it and of various other researches by Landau. Inform me please, more exactly, for what purpose my opinion is needed.
>
> Bohr

The *Izvestia* staff responded that they wanted to publish Bohr's evaluation in their newspaper. They did just that on 23 November, in an article that described Landau's idea and praised it highly:

> This work of Professor Landau's has aroused great interest among Soviet physicists, and his bold idea gives new life to one of the most important processes in astrophysics. There is every reason to think that Landau's new hypothesis will turn out to be correct and will lead to solutions to a whole series of unsolved problems in astrophysics.... Niels Bohr has given an extremely complimentary evaluation of the work of this Soviet scientist [Landau], saying that "The new idea of L. Landau is excellent and very promising."

This campaign was not enough to save Landau. Early in the morning of 28 April 1938, the knock came on the door of his apartment, and he was taken away in an official black limousine as his wife-to-be Cora watched in